ECONOMIC SURVEY 2012-13 ON AGRICULTURE

Comments and advisory inputs from the latest document may be summarised as follows –

- India's foodgrains production has shown remarkable improvement in recent years. The production of food-grains in 2011-12 was at a record high of **259.32** million tonnes. This achievement comes at a time when it is generally recognized that inadequate attention to agriculture across many parts of the world led to food shortages and steep hikes in food prices. In comparison, Indian agriculture has performed well primarily due to timely policy interventions. Nevertheless, the average annual growth rate of **3.6** per cent during the 11th Plan for the agriculture & allied sector fell short of the target of **4** per cent. Moreover the country faces the stiff challenge of feeding its growing population.
- A number of ***constraints*** and ***challenges*** remain to be addressed – the country will have to invest heavily in *farm research, rural infrastructure, providing better access to high value markets, better credit facilities* and *input use*, so that the farming community as a whole is motivated to produce more and the target of 4 per cent growth set for the agriculture and allied sector in the 12th Plan is met.
- Though India is one of the leading producers in the world of many major crops like paddy, wheat, pulses, sugarcane, spices, and plantation crops, the comparison in terms of ***yield*** levels is not creditable with it achieving a much lower rank in many of these crops – studies indicate that there are wide yield gaps among various crops across the country. Agriculture production can be substantially increased India addresses this yield gap by adopting *technological* and *policy* interventions. Improvement in yields holds the key for India to remain self-sufficient in foodgrains and also make a place for itself in many agricultural crops and products in the international market.